

just have a toolbar that has all the important file operations on it, there is an simple solution.

If you launch explorer you will notice that above the ribbon, in the titlebar area, there are a number of icons and a downward pointing arrow. You can “pin” operations from the ribbon to this toolbar and use them from there without using the ribbon UI at all. You can add individual items, individual options or even entire panes as items to this toolbar.

If you don't like the location up in the titlebar, you can click on the downward arrow and select “Show below the Ribbon” to move it to the area below the ribbon, but above the address bar.

Add Items to the [Win]+[X] Menu

If you are a power user you will find yourself using the [Win]+[X] shortcut for the Quick Link menu quite often. This menu appears where the start menu would in previous versions of Windows, and has links to some of the important tools in Windows 8.

While it just displays shortcuts in a set folder, Microsoft has taken measures to ensure that it doesn't become a dumping ground for shortcuts placed by every application a user installs. So it isn't possible to just create a shortcut there and expect it to show up; you need to use a third party application to do this. One such application is “Win+X Menu Editor for Windows 8”. This tool will let you create additional groups and add links to additional tools in this menu. You can find this application at www.winaero.com.

Start Using Storage Spaces

Imagine the following scenario – chances are something like this already happened to you – you just bought a new 250GB hard drive for all your movies and home videos. You call this drive “Videos”, this is more space than you will ever need you feel. In a year or so you realise that this isn't enough, not even close. Movies are HD now, and ripping a single Blu-Ray can take a fifth of the total space in your drive. Your digicam too is HD and chews though a GB as if it were nothing.

So you get another hard drive, 1TB this time, and it becomes “Videos 2”. Now you're stuck with two locations for the same kind of data, and in a year or so you will need “Videos 3”.

Now there is a solution to this mess, and it is called Storage Spaces. There are few concepts you need to understand about Storage Spaces to understand how it works.